

Yosemite National Park was created in 1890, thanks to the efforts of John Muir. The park is famed for its glaciers, waterfalls, and granite rock formations, such as the El Capitan monolith.

Fragile ecoregions

A concept that is now often used to identify the major habitat types on Earth is that of the ecoregion—smaller than a biome, with a more detailed gauge of biodiversity. Ecoregions are defined as large units of land or water containing a geographically distinct mix of species, natural communities, and environmental conditions. Some examples include deserts, tropical rainforests, temperate coniferous forests, lakes, mangrove swamps, and coral reefs. Of these, coral reefs and tropical rainforests are under particular threat from humankind.